

REACH

TEXT: 1 Chron. 28:1-8 *“David summoned all the officials of Israel to assemble at Jerusalem: the officers over the tribes, the commanders of the divisions in the service of the king, the commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds, and the officials in charge of all the property and livestock belonging to the king and his sons, together with the palace officials, the mighty men and all the brave warriors. 2 King David rose to his feet and said: "Listen to me, my brothers and my people. I had it in my heart to build a house as a place of rest for the ark of the covenant of the Lord, for the footstool of our God, and I made plans to build it. 3 But God said to me, 'You are not to build a house for my Name, because you are a warrior and have shed blood.' 4 "Yet the Lord, the God of Israel, chose me from my whole family to be king over Israel forever. He chose Judah as leader, and from the house of Judah he chose my*

family, and from my father's sons he was pleased to make me king over all Israel. 5Of all my sons--and the Lord has given me many--he has chosen my son Solomon to sit on the throne of the kingdom of the Lord over Israel. 6He said to me: 'Solomon your son is the one who will build my house and my courts, for I have chosen him to be my son, and I will be his father. 7I will establish his kingdom forever if he is unswerving in carrying out my commands and laws, as is being done at this time.' 8" So now I charge you in the sight of all Israel and of the assembly of the Lord, and in the hearing of our God: Be careful to follow all the commands of the Lord your God, that you may possess this good land and pass it on as an inheritance to your descendants forever."

INTRO: The setting for our Scripture text finds the most renowned King of Israel coming to the close of his reign. The reign of David over Judah and Israel has spanned some forty years.

If you were to print a chart or graph of the emotional climate of Israel during this forty year period it would no doubt resemble the blueprints of one of the worlds most daring roller coasters of all times!

Under the reign of David Israel knew day's of exhilarating victories, and devastating defeats! (From bringing the Ark home to Jerusalem, to 70,000 people dying because he numbered the people against the known will of God!)

David's own personal life paralleled that of the Kingdom! From killing Goliath, to sinning with Bathsheba!

Despite the victories and disappointments, David is now standing before Israel who is getting ready for the coronation of King Solomon (David's son), and he say's to them,
8" So now I charge you in the sight of all Israel and of the assembly of the Lord, and in the hearing of our God: Be careful to follow

all the commands of the Lord your God, that you may possess this good land and pass it on as an inheritance to your descendants forever.”

The story of David here is the story of the Bible! It is the story of the church! It is the story of rightly ordered families! Here it is; Capitalize on what has been left to you from the past: Seize the opportunities available in the present; Provide something for the future; Pass on what you can to the next generation!

The next five Sunday's we are going to dissect 1 Chronicles 28 & 29 using the subject “**POSSES THE LAND AND PASS IT ON**”. During the course of our time together our subtopics will be as follows:

- Looking back!
- Looking up!
- Looking within!
- Looking out!
- Looking forward!

The theme of this capital stewardship campaign is *“Praise For The Past, Faith For The Future”*! Today we are going to begin discovering how to **“POSSES THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”** through **“LOOKING BACK”**!

I. POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON THROUGH LOOKING BACK!

A. LOOKING BACK TO THE CALL... 1
Chron. 28:2-4 *“King David rose to his feet and said: ‘Listen to me, my brothers and my people. I had it in my heart to build a house as a place of rest for the ark of the covenant of the Lord, for the footstool of our God, and I made plans to build it. 3But God said to me, ‘You are not to build a house for my Name, because you are a warrior and have shed blood.’ 4”Yet the Lord, the God of Israel, chose me from my whole family to be king over Israel forever. He chose Judah as leader,*

and from the house of Judah he chose my family, and from my father's sons he was pleased to make me king over all Israel.” Here, David is “**LOOKING BACK**” on the method God chose in revealing his call to the Kingdom on his life.

- The nation is chosen!
- The family is chosen!
- The person is chosen!

The story of the call is laid out in 1 Samuel 16;

- Samuel goes to the house of Jesse to anoint a King!
- Seven sons are showcased before David is called in from the sheep herd!
- Only as a last resort is David considered!
- The horn of anointing oil was poured over his head! (He was never the same after that!)

At this juncture in David’s life I’m not sure he fully appreciated the full impact of what he was being called to! Reality began to set in **2**

Samuel 2:4-7 “*Then the men of Judah came*

to Hebron and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. When David was told that it was the men of Jabesh Gilead who had buried Saul, ⁵he sent messengers to the men of Jabesh Gilead to say to them, "The Lord bless you for showing this kindness to Saul your master by burying him. ⁶May the Lord now show you kindness and faithfulness, and I too will show you the same favor because you have done this. ⁷Now then, be strong and brave, for Saul your master is dead, and the house of Judah has anointed me king over them."

David reigned over Judah seven years, and over Israel and Judah thirty three years. The call of God, once received is not easily dispensed with!

I'm not sure that those who met in Magnolia Park, or the Oaklawn churches fully understood the impact of what they were beginning, but they were faithful to do what they could. Do you think it is possible that while they were meeting in the meager buildings of their beginning that they could have imagined the structure we are

meeting in today? Do you think they could have imagined the impact this church would have on the world through missions? I seriously doubt it! But they were faithful in “**POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON**”! Those people were true pioneers!

They capitalize on what was given to them! They seized the opportunities available to them at the time! They provided something for the future! They passed on what they could to the next generation!

What will history record of us? They used up what was given to them and left the next generation to fend for themselves? Or, will we provide something better for our children and grandchildren?

B. LOOKING BACK TO LEADERSHIP! 1
Chron. 29:1 *“Then King David said to the whole assembly: ‘My son Solomon, the one whom God has chosen, is young and*

inexperienced. The task is great, because this structure is not for man but for the Lord God.”

Here David acknowledges that Solomon is young and inexperienced, and facing a monumental task! I can't help but think that David was reflecting on his own lack of experience:

- When he fought with Goliath!
- When he became King the only experience he had was being a shepherd, and leading a band of misfits!

God delivered the Kingdom into David's hand through a bunch of downtrodden retreads and misfits! Don't you think David may have been reflecting on what God had wrought through such unlikely leadership?

(They had never been to a church growth seminar; A pastor's school; A John Maxwell seminar!!!)

David and his men **“POSSESSED THE LAND AND PASSED IT ON”**! Quite frankly, they **“PASSED ON”** more than they received! They were given a divided Kingdom ripped apart by war, and they **“PASSED ON”** a united Kingdom ready to build a Temple, and all the materials were provided, paid for, and ready for assembly!

I look back on the leadership of this great church and I am filled with two emotions:

- I am awed by the previous pastors and lay leadership! Pastoral leadership like Bro. and Sis. Yeats! Bro. and Sis. Weathers! Bro. and Sis. Keith! Bro. and Sis. Bates!
- Like David and his unlikely leadership team, each of them capitalized on what was given to them, seized the opportunities available to them at the time, provided something for the future and passed on what they could to the next generation, always leaving more than they were given!

What are we going to do? Set around and wait for a better time?

C. LOOKING BACK TO THE SOURCE! 1

Chron. 29:10-13 *“David praised the Lord in the presence of the whole assembly, saying, “Praise be to you, O Lord, God of our father Israel, from everlasting to everlasting.*

***11**Yours, O Lord, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the majesty and the splendor, for everything in heaven and earth is yours. Yours, O Lord, is the kingdom; you are exalted as head over all. **12**Wealth and honor come from you; you are the ruler of all things. In your hands are strength and power to exalt and give strength to all. **13**Now, our God, we give you thanks, and praise your glorious name.”*

David was very much aware that he was not capable of accomplishing even a fraction of what God had wrought, in his own ability! Think about how overwhelmed David would

have felt if Samuel had told David the day he came to Jesse's farmhouse, of all the accomplishments God wanted of him and his men! I'm sure he would have immediately admitted that he was not up to the task!

I want to point out two things here:

- God only reveals his will to us one step at a time, to keep from overwhelming us! Can you imagine how those early pioneers would have responded to paying \$284,000.00 for four acres of property? As much faith as they had this would have no doubt overwhelmed them! How did we get here? Through people **“POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON”**! How do we accomplish this project? By people **“POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON”**!
- We are not the source, God is! David knew that he and his band of misfits were going to need the help of God to do what God expected! Those early pioneers knew that if God did not help them they were in deep

trouble. I must admit that the task God is calling us to is overwhelming but I am not the source! You are not the source! Jehovah God is the source!

How do we accomplish this task? **“POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON!”** Let us rise up and capitalize on what has been given to us - Seize the opportunities that are available right now - Provide something for the future - Pass on something more than we were given to the next generation!!!

II. POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON THROUGH LOOKING UP!

A. LOOKING UP FOR AUTHORITY... 1

Chron. 28:8-9 *"So now I charge you in the sight of all Israel and of the assembly of the Lord, and in the hearing of our God: Be careful to follow all the commands of the Lord your God, that you may possess this good land and pass it on as an inheritance to your*

descendants forever. 9" And you, my son Solomon, acknowledge the God of your father, and serve him with wholehearted devotion and with a willing mind, for the Lord searches every heart and understands every motive behind the thoughts. If you seek him, he will be found by you; but if you forsake him, he will reject you forever."

King David was painfully aware of all the responsibilities and pitfalls of leadership. David was also cognizant of the fact that when you assume the role of leadership over a group of people that there will be times when it will be necessary for you to assume the role of being the “**AUTHORITY**” figure. (This will fly in the face of some folks.)

David say's two things to Solomon here;

- Vs. 8 *“Be careful to follow all the commands of the Lord your God...”* Vs. 9 *“acknowledge the God of your father, and serve him with wholehearted devotion and*

with a willing mind...” Get your marching orders from God, and only from God! David realized the “**AUTHORITY**” for leading a Kingdom must come from God! He knew that if Solomon tried to work his own agenda, he would destroy himself and everything he had been given.

- Vs. 8 “*that you may possess this good land and pass it on as an inheritance to your descendants forever.*” As a leader, if you get your orders from God, and follow them implicitly, you will “**POSSES THE LAND AND PASS IT ON**”! The flip side is, if you attempt your own agenda you will destroy what you have been given and have nothing to leave to the next generation!

In the New Testament, one of the commands given to Christians is to “*Honor the King*”. (1Peter 2:17) In other words we are to **Hebrews 13:17** “*Obey your leaders and submit to their authority. They keep watch over you as men who must give an account. Obey them so that*

their work will be a joy, not a burden, for that would be of no advantage to you.” There are two times to submit, when you agree, and when you disagree!

Allow me to give you some insight on this subject from the perspective of a person who is in “**AUTHORITY**” or leadership over a group of people. If you are going to lead people to the successful conclusion of any matter, whether it is small or great, those you are leading will need to know where you’re “**AUTHORITY**” comes from! As a Pastor my “**AUTHORITY**” to lead this church comes from God! I did not receive my “**AUTHORITY**” from a vote of the people!

As a person in “**AUTHORITY**” I must be aware that my accountability rests at the same level as my “**AUTHORITY**”! (I am accountable to God!) Every person who assumes a place of leadership in the spiritual realm should reflect on the accountability factor every day! I am going to have to answer to God

for how I led this church! I fear God more than I fear you!

If I decide not to lead this church forward because a few people don't think it is necessary, I must give an account for that! What I must do is hear from God, decide what he wants, and then lead you in that direction. When I have done that my responsibility has been completed. If you decide not to follow then God will deal with you!

The “**AUTHORITY**” to do what we are about to do comes from God, and I am convinced will be confirmed by the response of this body of believers! This is not about a real estate deal, or owning more property, or building more buildings. It is about having the tools necessary to reach this city for God!

B. LOOKING UP FOR ABILITY... 1 Chron. 29:14 *“But who am I, and who are my people, that we should be able to give as generously as*

this? Everything comes from you and we have given you only what comes from your hand.”

David was letting Solomon know that it doesn't matter how much **“ABILITY”** you think you have it will never be enough! True **“ABILITY”** to lead comes from God!

I am fully aware that I do not possess the natural **“ABILITY”** to lead this church where God is calling us to go. However, I am also aware that if I will look to God he will anoint me to do what I cannot otherwise do!

There are probably people sitting here today that would say this church does not have the **“ABILITY”** to give more than \$280,000.00 over and above our regular giving, in a four month period. You are probably right, but we are going to do three things;

- Look to God to give us the **“ABILITY”** to rise to the challenge! For those of you that think we have talked too much about money,

let me say that as the leader of this church I am attempting to get us to a place where we can rise to the challenge that faces us!

(Prepare your family for building a house)

- Call the resources necessary into our hands!
(We can call those things that are not as though they were!)
- When the resources come from God, recognize it, and place them where they belong! (I release a spirit of generosity and liberality on this congregation!)

God is not depending on our “ABILITY” to do his work He is going to give us Divine “ABILITY”!

C. LOOKING UP FOR ABUNDANCE... 1

Chron. 29:15-16 *“We are aliens and strangers in your sight, as were all our forefathers. Our days on earth are like a shadow, without hope.*

***16**O Lord our God, as for all this abundance that we have provided for building you a temple for your Holy Name, it comes from*

your hand, and all of it belongs to you.

Here, David is saying to Solomon;

- Our Fathers were commoners! This wealth did not come from them! Jesse did not leave us enough wealth to build a Temple! Saul did not leave enough wealth to build a Temple! I did not get this wealth by my own ingenuity. I am not clever enough to make all of this happen!
- This **“ABUNDANCE”** comes from God!
(That is what I am praying daily of the people of this congregation!)
- This **“ABUNDANCE”** was given to us to do the work of God! (Build him a temple!)

There are people that would argue that we are not able to do this project. (The 10 spies said the same thing.) I will agree that we are not up to the task within ourselves, but I am even more convinced that God is going to do it through us! The 12 spies were never asked to decide whether Israel could or should conquer the Promised Land, they were sent to develop a

military strategy that would insure the transfer of ownership from illegal squatters to rightful owners!

“LOOK UP!” The blessings are beginning to fall from the sky! **Psalm 121:1-2** *“I will lift up mine eyes unto the hills, from whence cometh my help. 2My help cometh from the Lord, which made heaven and earth.”*

When I was a young child in church we used to sing a song that went something like this, *“The prayers go up, and the blessings will come down. The prayers go up, and the blessings will come down. The prayers go up, and the blessings will come down. So build your house on the Lord Jesus Christ.”*

SONG: “Only Believe”

III. POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON THROUGH LOOKING WITHIN!

A. LOOKING WITHIN FOR DIRECTION -

A PERSON TO CAST VISION... 1 Chron.

28:5-6 *“Of all my sons--and the Lord has given me many--he has chosen my son Solomon to sit on the throne of the kingdom of the Lord over Israel. 6He said to me: 'Solomon your son is the one who will build my house and my courts, for I have chosen him to be my son, and I will be his father.’”* To be able to

grasp all that David is saying to his son Solomon here you must first understand where David is coming from. He has led the Kingdom through much difficulty and adversity. (He faced problems from without - foreign enemies who were a constant threat. He has faced problems from within - Absalom.)

He has no intention of turning the Kingdom over to just anybody! The individual, upon whom the mantle of leadership was to fall, had to be tailor-made for the job!

David mentions the fact that the Lord had given him many sons, yet, God had Solomon waiting

in the wings, as the person to whom the kingdom would be handed off.

In the Kingdom of God Leadership is never a one man race, it is always a relay! God never just lays out a plan that will span the life of just one individual he always connects us to our predecessors and successors! (That in and of itself is a lot of pressure!) In leadership the challenge then becomes, do what you can with what you have been given, and then **“PASS IT ON”** to the person who is waiting in the wings. (Never forget, God always has someone waiting in the wings.) Leadership is really all about **“POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON”**!

David **“POSSESSED THE LAND AND PASSED IT ON”** to someone “WITHIN” his own house! Why do you suppose of all of David’s sons, God chose Solomon to lead this Nation?

- Solomon had a heart to seek God!

- Solomon was a person who was capable of giving “**DIRECTION**” to the Kingdom and “**CASTING VISION**”!

When you look back over the history of this church to the leaders who have been successful in bringing this church to where it is at, you will become aware that they were a very diverse group of people. Yet, there is a common thread that runs through each of them... They were willing to receive “**DIRECTION**” from God, and then “**CAST VISION**” within this house.

I don't know why God has placed me here at this time. I am aware that there are many people who seem to be more capable than I. The only thing I know for sure is that I am willing to receive “**DIRECTION**” from God, and then “**CAST VISION**” within this body!

Because God has seen fit to place me in this body as the “**LEADER**” I must assume that I am the best person for the job, and do my best to

“POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”!

We need to **“LOOK WITHIN FOR DIRECTION”**. The course has been set we must strive for the goal!

B. LOOKING WITHIN FOR DIVERSITY OF SKILLS - PEOPLE WHO ARE WILLING TO POOL THEIR GIFTS... 1

Chron. 28:21 *“The divisions of the priests and Levites are ready for all the work on the temple of God, and every willing man skilled in any craft will help you in all the work. The officials and all the people will obey your every command.”* Solomon must have felt somewhat overwhelmed when confronted with such a formidable task of leading a Kingdom, and building a House for God that would be very costly and have such intricate details! We have no record of any previous building experience on the part of Solomon.

David does not place all of the responsibility for

building this house on the shoulders of Solomon. He **“LOOKS WITHIN FOR PEOPLE WHO ARE WILLING TO POOL THEIR GIFTS”**;

- He promises that the Priests and the Levites are prepared to assist in the construction of this place of worship!
- He promises that every man who is skilled in crafts will stand ready to help! (Carpenters, plumbers, electricians, welders, painters, heavy equipment operators, landscapers, interior decorators, butlers, bankers and candlestick makers etc...)
- He promises the leaders will be willing to get their hands dirty in the work!

Just as Solomon was going to need the participation of the people from every level, this church has been brought to this point because the people have involved themselves. Can you imagine how much recourses and **“GIFTS”** have been given over throughout the history of Christian Temple so we could be where we are

today?

If those who have gone before us were called upon to do what they could (Make sacrifices), we must be willing to make the same kind of sacrifice so that we can **“POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”!**

While proper leadership is of ultimate importance, leadership in and of itself cannot accomplish the goal that God has called us to. If this goal is to be accomplished, it will take a team effort! (Example - On Sat. Sept. 23rd, 2000 Arkansas faced Alabama, a game they were not supposed to win - In the fourth quarter, Arkansas was trailing Alabama by a score of 21 to 20, and Cedric Cobb's Arkansas star tailback left the game with a separated shoulder, and his backup Fred Talley was already gone with a broken hand. A young man, Alvin Ray of whom most of us knew very little, came into that game and helped the Razorbacks to a 28-21 victory!)

If we are to succeed, we must “**LOOK WITHIN**”! Everyone must get involved!

C. LOOKING WITHIN FOR DEDICATION TO REACH THE GOAL - PROJECT COMPLETION... 1 Chron. 28:20

“David also said to Solomon his son, “Be strong and courageous, and do the work. Do not be afraid or discouraged, for the Lord God, my God is with you. He will not fail you or forsake you until all the work for the service of the temple of the Lord is finished.” David say’s several things to Solomon here;

- *“**Be strong and courageous...**”* David knew that Solomon was going to need an infusion of strength and courage. Doing the work of God is not for the fainthearted. If those who established this church had turned tail and fled at the first sign of adversity, where do you think we would be right now? We need to be infused with strength and courage, for the task will not be easily accomplished. The enemy will no doubt fight every step of the way. Are

we going to give up at the first threat or sign of danger, or will we “**LOOK WITHIN FOR DEDICATION TO REACH THE GOAL**”?

- *“Do the work...”* David knew that when the coronation was over Solomon was going to have his hands full! The coronation is the easy part! After coronation comes lots of hard work! Getting this church to this point was no easy task. There are people who have sweated blood to have us where we are today. This task is not for the weak willed. We must have people who are “**DEDICATED TO REACHING THE GOAL**”!
- *“The Lord God, my God, is with you...”* David does not just saddle Solomon with commands of responsibility, but also makes him the promise, that the God who has guided him from victory to victory for more than forty years, would also be with him. I am here to tell you that the God, who has led this church throughout its history, will be with us in this endeavor!!! We are not going to need to do this alone we have been called to be

“Laborers together with God”. We are God’s partners in this work! Can we find it in our hearts to **“DEDICATE OURSELVES TO REACHING THIS GOAL”**?

- *“He will not fail you or forsake you until all the work for the service of the temple of the Lord is finished.”* David makes Solomon the promise, that as long as he is doing what God has called him to do, that God will be with him, and there will be a guarantee of completing the task. Those who have gone before us have in effect contributed to the completion of this vision. They contributed to the cause with their sacrifices of faith, labor, and love! The same promise of completion that was given to David, Solomon, and our forefathers, is being extended to us! We cannot fail! God is on our side! All we must do is to become **“DEDICATED TO REACHING THE GOAL”**?

I want to close today with the words of David found in **1 Chron. 29:5** *“for the gold work and*

the silver work, and for all the work to be done by the craftsmen. Now, who is willing to consecrate himself today to the Lord?" Here David draws a line and asks the people to **“DEDICATE THEMSELVES TO REACHING THE GOAL”!**

For us, this is a project that will cost in excess of \$280,000.00, are we up to it? Can we **“LOOK WITHIN”** and find something that will cause us to **“DEDICATE OURSELVES TO REACHING THE GOAL”?**

Notice the response of the people **1 Chron. 29:6**
“Then the leaders of families, the officers of the tribes of Israel, the commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds, and the officials in charge of the king's work gave willingly.”

What a response! This is exactly the kind of response we must have, if we hope to **“POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”!**

Are you up to it? Are we up to it?

IV. POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON THROUGH LOOKING OUT!

**A. LOOKING OUT TO CALCULATE
WHERE THE VISION (journey) WILL
TAKE US... 1 Chron. 28:9-10** *“And you, my
son Solomon, acknowledge the God of your
father, and serve him with wholehearted
devotion and with a willing mind, for the Lord
searches every heart and understands every
motive behind the thoughts. If you seek him,
he will be found by you; but if you forsake
him, he will reject you forever. **10** Consider
now, for the Lord has chosen you to build a
temple as a sanctuary. Be strong and do the
work.”*

For the past few weeks I have been preaching
the “**VISION**” of Christian Temple. Many of
you bought into the “**VISION**” long ago, others

of you have just recently come alongside the “**VISION**”, and there are yet others who have not decided where you fit into the “**VISION**” of the house. In the first part of this sermon I will be mostly talking to those who are still in the undecided category.

First of all I want to tell you that I do not fault you for being slow to get on board. You should always “**CALCULATE WHERE THE VISION IS TAKING YOU**”. Jesus himself said that a person who builds a house without first counting the cost is a fool. Before you buy into a “**VISION**” you should always “**CALCULATE**” the cost!

I must tell you that as the leader of this church...

- ... I believe God is taking us on a journey.
- ... I believe I know what the end result of that journey will be.
- ... I have decided I want to go where the path leads.

Thus I have become willing to embrace, and support the “VISION”. I am going to “POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”.

I want to point out two very important components of buying into and embracing a “VISION”:

- You must get your heart right! David told Solomon that if he hoped to accomplish the “VISION” that had been “PASSED” to him, he must “*serve God with wholehearted devotion*”! **Matthew 12:35** “*A good man out of the good treasure of the heart bringeth forth good things: and an evil man out of the evil treasure bringeth forth evil things.*” **Matthew 6:19-21** “*Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. 20 But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. 21 For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.*” This thing of

buying into a “**VISION**” requires you to take ownership, which means the need to see it accomplished must be greater than the willingness to allow it to fail. The “**VISION**” must find its way into your heart! For a “**VISION**” to get into your heart, you must first “**CALCULATE**” where the “**VISION**” is taking you, and how you can be involved in its successful completion. This means you have severed all other options.

- You must get yourself into a mindset that say’s no matter what happens I will do my part to accomplish the “**VISION**”. You cannot be successful in any area of your life unless you have your mind made up! (My first memories of church is hearing old-timers testify and say “when God saved me he gave me a made up mind to serve him”! And serve him they did, sometimes against all odds!) That is precisely where we must get, have a made up mind to fulfill the “**VISION**” God has placed in this house!

David was saying to Solomon, if you do not allow this thing to become your very heartbeat, and condition your mind to believe you can accomplish this task, it will never get done! You must have your mind made up to **“POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”!**

In the process of bringing any **“VISION”** to pass, there comes a time to quit talking about it, and just rise up and do it. If you have your heart right, and your mind right, you have **“CALCULATED WHERE THE VISION IS TAKING YOU”** and you have decided you want to be apart of it, would you rise up and help us build the Lord’s house?

B. LOOKING OUT TO CONDITION YOUR SELF TO FULFILL THE VISION...

Notice the words of David to Solomon in **1 Chron. 28:10** *“Consider now, for the Lord has chosen you to build a temple as a sanctuary. Be strong and do the work.”* Because of 40 years of experience in leading the Kingdom,

David knew that Solomon was going to need to **“CONDITION HIMSELF TO FULFILL THE VISION”**! He knew that everything was not just going to fall into place there would be many difficulties to face in the completion of the **“VISION”**! For that reason David told Solomon *“Be strong and do the work”*, in other words **“CONDITION YOUR SELF TO FULFILL THE VISION”**.

We live in a time where the world has fallen prey to an infatuation with being physically fit. Certainly, there is nothing wrong with exercise and keeping your physical body in shape. (You can tell by looking at me that this is very important to me as well! Ha!)

When you begin an exercise routine you must work into it slowly or your body will let you know that you have gone too far! It is absolutely amazing what the human body is capable of, if it is first **“CONDITIONED”** to do so. (Olympic gymnastics)

The New Testament repeatedly compares the church to the human body. I wonder what we are really capable of, if we take time to **“CONDITION OURSELVES TO FULFILL THE VISION”**.

If we **“CONDITION OURSELVES TO FULFILL THE VISION”** I am convinced that at the very worst we are capable of **“POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON”**!

When David told Solomon *“Be strong and do the work”* he was saying this mission is possible, if you **“CONDITION”** yourself to do it. Church, I want to tell you today that if we will **“CONDITION OURSELVES TO FULFILL THE VISION”** nothing will be impossible!

C. LOOKING OUT TO CONTRIBUTE TO THE FULFILLMENT OF THE VISION... 1

Chron. 29:6-9 *“Then the leaders of families, the officers of the tribes of Israel, the commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds, and the officials in charge of the king's work gave willingly. ⁷They gave toward the work on the temple of God five thousand talents and ten thousand darics of gold, ten thousand talents of silver, eighteen thousand talents of bronze and a hundred thousand talents of iron. ⁸Any who had precious stones gave them to the treasury of the temple of the Lord in the custody of Jehiel the Gershonite. ⁹The people rejoiced at the willing response of their leaders, for they had given freely and wholeheartedly to the Lord. David the king also rejoiced greatly.”*

Remember, I told you in a previous sermon that David promised Solomon that the leaders and the people were ready to **“FULFILL THE VISION”**. The response of those who were in leadership was absolutely overwhelming that day! They **“CONTRIBUTED”** a cumulative

total of \$166, 864,320.00 toward the
“FULFILLMENT OF THE VISION”! This
is absolutely awesome when you realize that the
people have not even had an opportunity to give
yet. The leadership of Israel was intent on
**“POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING
IT ON”!**

Why do you suppose the response was so great?

- They had **“CALCULATED WHERE THE
VISION WAS TAKING THEM”**, and they
wanted to go!
- They had **“CONDITIONED
THEMSELVES TO FULFILL THE
VISION”**. They had their hearts right, and
their minds ready because they were set on
**“POSSESSING THE LAND AND
PASSING IT ON”!**
- They were ready to **“CONTRIBUTE TO
THE FULFILLMENT OF THE VISION”!**

How can you **“CONTRIBUTE TO THE
FULFILLMENT OF THE VISION”?**

- **PRAY** - Pray that God would let you know

what you should commit (This has nothing to do with what you can see right now). Pray that the resources would be placed in your hands. Pray that you will have the courage and generosity to **“PASS THE RESOURCES ON”**! Pray that the leadership will make good decisions! Pray that other members of the body will do the same!

- **GIVE** - Be willing to give of your time, talent, and resources. If the church is alive it will always cost money. The more alive it is, the more money it will cost. Living churches have space problems - Dead churches have lots of unused space. Living churches are always changing things - Dead churches just stay the same. The people in living churches struggle to learn new names - In dead churches no one new has shown up for years. Living churches are constantly developing new leaders - Dead churches just keep using the same ones over and over. Living churches spend large amounts of money on missions - Dead churches keep it all at home. Living churches

are filled with generous givers - Dead churches are populated with tippers.

- **BE SUPPORTIVE** - The leadership of this church needs your support more now than ever before. See what you can do to make it easy for leadership to lead. Be supportive with your actions, words, and deeds!

I want to close with three questions today:

- Are you ready to **“LOOK OUT”** far enough to be able to **“CALCULATE WHERE THE VISION IS TAKING YOU”** and your family, and have enough faith to say we are ready to do our part to **“POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”**?
- Do you have what it takes to **“CONDITION YOURSELF TO FULFILL THE VISION”**? Are you in any shape to **“POSSESS THE LAND AND PASS IT ON”**?
- Are you ready to go above and beyond, to **“CONTRIBUTE TO THE FULFILLMENT OF THE VISION”**? Are

you ready to give it up for the call?

V. POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT ON THROUGH FAITH!

**A. LOOKING FORWARD THROUGH
CONFIDENCE IN THE VISION...** Notice the words of David when he prays for Israel and Solomon in **1 Chron. 29:18-19** “*O Lord God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, our fathers, keep this (The Vision) for ever in the imagination of the thoughts of the heart of thy people, and prepare their heart unto thee:*

***19** And give unto Solomon my son a perfect heart, to keep thy commandments, thy testimonies, and thy statutes, and to do all these things (The Vision), and to build the palace, for the which I have made provision.*”

David has “**POSSESSED THE LAND**” and now he is getting ready to “**PASS IT ON**” to his son Solomon and the next generation. He is praying that they will “**LOOK FORWARD WITH CONFIDENCE IN THE VISION**”!

The “**VISION**” was larger and of more

importance than David, or his generation. The **“VISION”** was of such importance that it would transcend all barriers. (Generational, gender, racial, religious, etc...)

What we are doing here today is bigger than a person, church, or organization. We are in effect deciding whether we are going to take ownership in the **“VISION”** God is attempting to set among us. We don't catch and buy into a **“VISION”** naturally we must lay hold of it through **“FAITH”**.

“FAITH” is a very important word in the Christian vocabulary. I love to preach about **“FAITH”**, it is one of my favorite subjects. (I am so fond of Hebrews 11 that it has been completely worn out of two of my Bibles!) Many discussions have transpired over what this word **“FAITH”** really means. The book of Hebrews gives us a better definition of this word than Webster himself. **Hebrews 11:1** *“Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the*

evidence of things not seen.” The word “*substance*” comes from the Greek word “*hupostasis*” (hoop-os’-tas-is), and means “**CONFIDENCE**”. The word “*hoped*” comes from the Greek word “*elpizo*” (el-pid’-zo), and means to expect or trust. . The word “*evidence*” comes from the Greek word “*elegchos*” (el’-eng-khos), and means proof. So we could paraphrase Hebrews 11:1 to read, “*Now faith is the ingredient that provides confidence in the things we are expecting, the proof of the things we have not yet seen with our natural eye.*”

I want to ask you today, can you exercise your “**FAITH**” enough to take ownership of the “**VISION**” God has set among us? Are you willing to “**POSSES THE LAND AND PASS IT ON BY LOOKING FORWARD WITH CONFIDENCE IN THE VISION**”?

B. LOOKING FORWARD THROUGH CONFIDENCE IN LEADERSHIP...

1 Chron. 28:5-6 “*And of all my sons, (for the*

*Lord hath given me many sons,) he hath
chosen Solomon my son to sit upon the throne
of the kingdom of the Lord over Israel. **6** And
he said unto me, Solomon thy son, he shall
build my house and my courts: for I have
chosen him to be my son, and I will be his
father.”*

David is saying that of all my sons God has
chosen Solomon to reign over Israel at this time!
Would Solomon make mistakes? Yes! Would
Solomon be limited in what he could
accomplish? Yes, he is not superman! Would
Solomon be misunderstood? Yes! Would
Solomon reign forever? No!

There are some laws God has set in motion in
his church. One of which is that he has chosen
earthly **“LEADERSHIP”** to function under
Christ who has been chosen to be the head of
the church. (Explain the chain of command in
the church.) The problem with earthly
“LEADERSHIP” is that;

- ... It is human!
- ... It sometimes makes mistakes!
- ... It has certain limitations!
- ... It is often misunderstood!
- ... It is temporary!

Earthly “**LEADERSHIP**” is nonetheless necessary. If for some reason I decided to step down from being the Pastor of this church, you would have an immediate need for new earthly “**LEADERSHIP**”!

Before you can really buy into a “**VISION**” you must be able to have “**CONFIDENCE IN LEADERSHIP**”. You may be setting there saying to yourself “*I can’t buy into the vision because leadership has made mistakes*”. I will be the first to agree with you, but let me point out two very important things here:

- You should never expect more of “**LEADERSHIP**” than you are willing to give. Don’t hold “**LEADERSHIP**” to one standard of conduct, and then live by another

standard yourself!

- Always remember this is earthly “**LEADERSHIP**” you are dealing with here! Earthly “**LEADERSHIP**” will create human error! That does not mean they are not fit to “**LEAD**” that just means they are human.

The question that must be asked by any individual, family or church when deciding whether or not to buy into a “**VISION**”, thus expressing “**CONFIDENCE IN LEADERSHIP**” is, do I believe the person who is leading me has their heart in the right place? Do they have my best interest at heart? Do they have the best interest of the church at heart? Do they want to fulfill the great commission? Are they doing this to build their ego, or to follow God? If you believe they have their heart in the right place, then it is your responsibility to follow and support the “**VISION**”. In so doing you are in effect “**POSSESSING THE LAND AND PASSING IT BY LOOKING FORWARD WITH CONFIDENCE IN**

LEADERSHIP”!

C. LOOKING FORWARD THROUGH CONFIDENCE IN GOD... **1 Chron. 28:7**

*“Moreover I will establish his kingdom for ever, if he be constant to do my commandments and my judgments, as at this day.” **1 Chron. 28:20** “And David said to Solomon his son, Be strong and of good courage, and do it: fear not, nor be dismayed: for the Lord God, even my God, will be with thee; he will not fail thee, nor forsake thee, until thou hast finished all the work for the service of the house of the Lord.”* The task that Solomon was being called upon to do would be no easy assignment. David say’s to Solomon that if he will place his “**CONFIDENCE IN GOD**”, that God will use him to turn the “**VISION**” into a reality! Solomon would be unable to accomplish this within himself, he needed to express “**CONFIDENCE IN GOD**” If he could bring himself to do this, he would have the privilege of being a part of God’s

program on earth!

Can we accomplish this alone? No! We **MUST** have God's help, or we will fall flat on our face! This is not my **"VISION"** it is His **"VISION"**. Through becoming involved with it I am expressing my **"CONFIDENCE IN GOD"**! I am not able but He is!!! **Hebrews 11:6** ***"But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him."***

I want to be heard to say it one more time loud and clear you cannot please God without,

- ... Allowing yourself to have **"CONFIDENCE IN A VISION"**...
- ... Placing **"CONFIDENCE IN LEADERSHIP"**...

But the most important thing is for you and I to express our **"CONFIDENCE IN GOD"**! This is God's **"VISION"** not ours! We are partnering with him! (If we all pull together)

In order to please God you must buy into a **“VISION”** somewhere. Can you think of a better **“VISION”** in this City? Do you think there is another church that wants to reach this city more than Christian Temple does? I urge you to buy into this **“VISION”** thus expressing **“CONFIDENCE IN GOD”**!

Can you think of any greater accomplishment on earth than to accept a **“VISION”** that God is casting, and being used by Him to bring it to pass?

Are you willing to **“POSSES THE LAND AND PASS IT ON THROUGH LOOKING FORWARD, TO THE VISION, TO LEADERSHIP, AND TO GOD”**?